

Is that what they call breaking news?

INDRAJIT DAS, *Delhi*

Winning Formula

With Indian cricket at its nadir, Formula 1 race might actually be successful in drawing people's attention ("NK's New Race", July 30). However, as it's an expensive game, there may not be too many takers for it. HIMANGSHU BHUYAN, *Bangalore*

What Narayan Karthikeyan has achieved is really commendable, especially when there is not much awareness about the game in India. He's much better than our over-glamourised cricketers.

PRANJAL GAUTAM, *Delhi*

Moll in Movies

Bollywood seems to have a strange fixation for those associated with the underworld ("Freedom in Sight", July 30). First, it was Sanjay Dutt who succeeded in bagging roles even after his alleged involvement in the 1993 Mumbai blasts. Now, it is jailbird Monica Bedi's turn to step into Bollywood. It is ironic that a flop actress like her wants to return to movies even after being labelled as Abu Salem's moll.

M.M. KALE, *on e-mail*

Speech-less

A speech is effective when the speaker is passionate about the subject and speaks from his heart ("Figure of Speech", July 30). The impact is more when he strictly keeps it short. In today's age, not many abide by this rule

and their speeches are mostly monotonous.

VIRENDRA KUMAR TANGRI, *Dehradun*

Respect Style

Singer-actor-musician Himesh Reshammiya's effort to set a new trend in the industry is commendable ("Seedhi Baat", July 30). Critics and analysts should respect his style and realise that he is not competing with any other star in Bollywood.

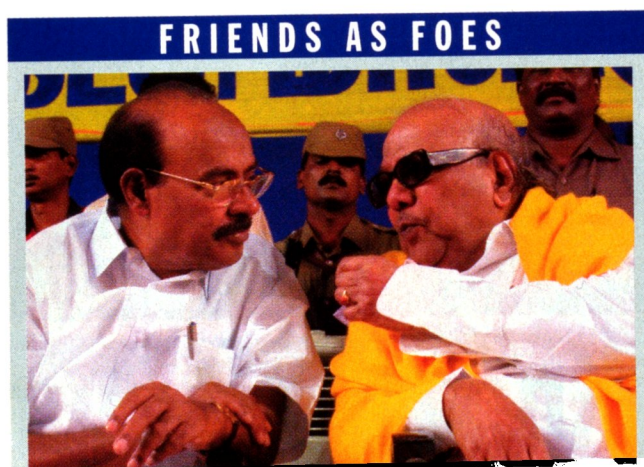
MANSI ANEJA, *Delhi*

Counting Days?

The story on Pakistan gives an insight into what is in store for General Pervez Musharraf ("Drawing a Bloodline", July 23).

While he openly says that he is fighting a war against the extremists, it now needs to be seen if the deal between his party and the PPP materialises as that will eventually determine whether his days are numbered.

CHETAN PRABHAKAR, *Gurgaon*



Coalition politics has actually benefited politicians like S. Ramadoss, who can wield power irrespective of poll results ("Ruling Opposition", July 30). If this time he has partnered with M. Karunanidhi, next time he will surely join hands with J. Jayalalithaa.

TAPAN JYOTI BARMAN, *Chennai*

Ramadoss is actually behaving like a responsible ally. By turning down Jayalalithaa's offer, the PMK founder has proved that his aim is betterment of Tamil Nadu.

SANJANI RAO, *Chennai*

Friction seems to be growing within the DMK-led DPA Government of Tamil Nadu. While Ramadoss's protests have brought much embarrassment to Karunanidhi, his rejection of Jayalalithaa's offer has confused the Opposition.

SRILA VENKATESH, *Delhi*

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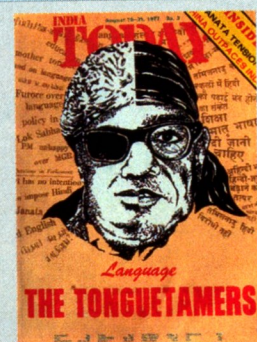
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Years Ago in India Today

AUGUST 16-31, 1977



Staging a Comeback?

Was Mrs Indira Gandhi's three-day trip to Paunar (70 km from Nagpur) a prelude to her re-entry into active politics? Despite her statement that she did not discuss politics with Acharya Vinoba Bhave, her proposed country-wide tour in September has increasingly led observers to speculate about her staging a comeback. This was her first officially announced trip out of Delhi since she stepped down in March. At the ashram she met Acharya seven times. The first meeting lasted only four minutes. The others over an hour. During the written conversations—the Acharya cannot hear—besides Mrs Gandhi and Acharya—those present were Nirmal Deshpande, a close disciple of the Acharya and Bai Tembhakar. None revealed the nature or subjects discussed. In her meetings with the press later, she however, said she would come back only if people wanted.



Mrs Gandhi

—Vijay Phanshakar